

Helen Lam

Ph.D. Candidate in Applied Microeconomics

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RESEARCH INTERESTS AND RESEARCH PROJECTS

My research focuses on health economics and applied microeconomics, particularly on human capital, child health and development, and equality of opportunity. I study how early-life conditions shape inequality in health and socioeconomic outcomes. Leveraging large-scale administrative and longitudinal data from the Netherlands, I examine intergenerational mobility across the life course, from birth to adulthood, and across domains including health, education, labor markets, and housing. Additionally, I apply causal inference methods to identify the effects of adverse birth outcomes on early childhood health and development.

Research Projects

I am currently working on the following research projects, applying big data and econometric analysis methods:

- **Equality of Opportunity:** Analyze intergenerational mobility across health, education, labor market, and housing using large administrative datasets. We publish our results on www.opportunitymap.nl
- **Birth Inequalities:** Examine the impact of parental income and neighborhood context on birth outcomes and early childhood development using quantitative and econometric methods.
- **Birth Weight:** Examine the effects of adverse birth outcomes on early childhood health and development using large-scale administrative data.

EDUCATION

- **Ph.D. Applied Microeconomics & Health Economics** Rotterdam, NL
Erasmus School of Health Policy and Management, Erasmus University Rotterdam Oct. 2022 – Present
- **MSc. Economics and Business** Rotterdam, the Netherlands
Erasmus School of Economics, Erasmus University Rotterdam Sep. 2018 – Aug. 2019
- **BSc. Economics and Business Economics** Rotterdam, NL
Erasmus School of Economics, Erasmus University Rotterdam Sep. 2015 – Aug. 2018

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

- **Research Internship ABN Amro** Amsterdam, NL
Group Economics, Strategy & Innovation, ABN Amro Mar. 2023 - Dec. 2024
 - **Big Data:** Conducted economic research using large-scale bank transaction data, generating innovative and data-driven insights.
 - **Data Processing:** Processed, cleaned, and prepared high-volume datasets with PySpark, Databricks, and Python for advanced analyses.
 - **Interdisciplinary Research:** Collaborated with economists and data scientists on interdisciplinary research projects.
- **Predoctoral Fellowship Applied Economics** Rotterdam, NL
Department of Applied Economics, Erasmus University Rotterdam Nov. 2021 - Sep. 2022
 - **Data Processing::** Cleaned, aggregated, and organized large-scale administrative CBS microdata.
 - **Data Analysis::** Performed quantitative analyses and generated insights from CBS microdata for multiple research projects.
 - **Data Visualization::** Created clear visualizations and graphical outputs for reports, presentations, and online publications; developed an interactive dashboard opportunitygap.nl/ to make results publicly accessible.

- **Data Steward** Utrecht, NL
ODISSEI Social Data Science Team (SoDa), Utrecht University Dec. 2020 - Sep. 2021
 - **R tidyverse:** Rewrote, cleaned, and organized kansenkaart code with R tidyverse into multiple pipelines
 - **Data analysis:** cleaned, analyzed, and generated data output with CBS microdata
 - **GitHub:** Created and managed several GitHub repositories for kansenkaart so that the code to generate the kansenkaart estimates are open to the public

- **Research Assistant Health economics** Rotterdam, NL
Department of Applied Economics, Erasmus University Rotterdam Sep. 2019 - Sep. 2020

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- **Economics of Health and Health Care** Master Health Economics,
Erasmus School of Health Policy and Management, Erasmus University Rotterdam 2025 - 2026
- **Seminar Health, Behaviour, and Wellbeing** Economics Bachelor 3
Erasmus School of Economics, Erasmus University Rotterdam 2025 - 2026
- **Introduction to Econometrics** Economics Bachelor 2
Erasmus School of Economics, Erasmus University Rotterdam 2022 - 2023
- **Research Project** Economics Bachelor 2
Erasmus School of Economics, Erasmus University Rotterdam 2019 - 2020

CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS

- Smarter Choices for Better Health conference, Rotterdam (Netherlands) 2026
- European Winter Meeting Econometric Society, Mallorca (Spain), 2024
- European Health Economics Association Conference, Vienna (Austria), 2024
- American Society of Health Economics Conference, San Diego (United States), 2024
- Smarter Choices for Better Health PhD Day, Rotterdam (Netherlands) 2023
- Health Equity Workshop, Rotterdam (Netherlands) 2023
- Kenniscentrum Ongelijkheid Voorjaarsconferentie, Amsterdam (Netherlands), 2022

PUBLICATIONS

- **Book Sociale verloskunde (Social obstetrics)** Sep. 2021
Bookchapter 3 Urgency: pregnancy and inequality of opportunity on the KansenKaart
 - **Bookchapter:** Chapter dedicated to the KansenKaart results for the birth outcomes: small-for-gestational age and preterm birth
 - **Citation:** Lam, H. C. & Ravesteijn, B. (2021). Urgentie: zwangerschap en kansenongelijkheid op de KansenKaart. In E. A. P. Steegers, A. Waelput, P. Peeters (Ed.), *Sociale verloskunde* (pp. 49-60). Bohn Stafleu van Loghum.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Dutch (Native), English (Fluent), Cantonese (Conversational), Mandarin (Basic), German (limited)
- **Technical skills:** R (including parallel library for parallel computing), Stata, Python, Pyspark, Bash scripting
- **Version control:** Git